LOW-WASTE HOME

Pantry-First Meal Planner

Plan the week from the food you already have, then shop for the gaps only.

Printable PDF · A4 and US Letter · low-ink edition

13 pages including cover
Digital download. Printable PDF. Not editable.

START HERE

How this planner works

1. Fill in your fridge, freezer and pantry (5 minutes).
2. Build meals from what you have first.
3. Plan the week and note leftover destinations.
4. Write a top-up list for only the gaps.
5. Review the week and adjust next time.

Use what you have first. Buying less is the goal; a full plan is not required.

STOCK CHECK

Fridge

Item	Quantity	Use by (if known)	Use first?	Notes

STOCK CHECK

Freezer and pantry

Item	Quantity	Date frozen

Item	Quantity	Running low?

USE-FIRST QUEUE

Ingredients to use this week

Ingredient	Meal idea	What else do I need?	Done?

- [ ] Start with anything fresh.
- [ ] Check the freezer for batch-cooked meals.
- [ ] Use up pantry items that are close to their date.

SEVEN-DAY PLAN

This week

Day	Meal	Uses which stock?	Leftovers go to

LEFTOVERS

Leftover destinations

- [ ] Lunch the next day
- [ ] Freeze in a labelled portion
- [ ] Soup or stock
- [ ] Sandwich or wrap
- [ ] Compost or food share

Leftovers I expect this week

TOP-UP LIST

Shop for the gaps only

Item	Why needed	Already have?	Pack size	Done?

Compare pack sizes by unit price before buying.

EXAMPLE

Completed example: one week

COMPLETED EXAMPLE

Pantry-first week

Day	Meal	Uses which stock?	Leftovers go to

Example: lentils and a half onion from the pantry became Monday’s dhal. Tuesday used the leftover dhal in a wrap.

REVIEW

Weekly review

What worked?

What got wasted, and why?

What will I change next week?

REFERENCE

Storage and labels

Check your own food-storage guidance for safe storage times. This planner does not set storage periods.

Notes

REPEAT

Monthly reset

- [ ] Clear the fridge of anything past its date
- [ ] Check the freezer inventory
- [ ] Update the pantry list
- [ ] Choose one habit to keep for next month

Next month’s focus

NOTES

Notes

Notes

YOUR DOWNLOAD

What is in your download

- [ ] pantry-first-meal-planner-letter.pdf: Pantry-First Meal Planner, US Letter print edition
- [ ] pantry-first-meal-planner-low-ink.pdf: low-ink edition (same layout, lighter panels)
- [ ] START_HERE.pdf: this page and the instructions

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